

Marneh John Luceñara

Executive Assistant & Business Partner | Project & Freelancer Management | AI-Powered Operations

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Versatile, highly independent Executive Assistant with 3+ years functioning as the central operational hub for founders, managing partners, and C-suite executives across venture capital and global consumer brands. Proven "jack of all trades" who manages projects and freelancers end to end, sources and screens contractors and candidates, runs high-volume research and outreach, and provides full personal-life support, all without needing constant direction. Builds repeatable, AI-powered workflows using Claude and ChatGPT daily, pairing automation with strong human judgment and quality control. Comfortable with numbers-driven, high-volume work and operating independently across time zones with a high level of discretion, ownership, and follow-through.

CORE EXPERTISE

Project & Freelancer Management · Contractor Sourcing, Screening & Evaluation · Recruiting & Candidate Shortlisting · Lead Generation & High-Volume Outreach (Apollo, LinkedIn) · AI-Powered Workflows (Claude, ChatGPT) · Executive Calendar & Inbox Management · Vendor & Service Provider Coordination · Personal Life & Travel Logistics · CRM Architecture & Administration · Investor & Business Research · Expense Tracking & Reporting · Process Improvement & Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Executive Assistant to the Founder & CMO

Ekster

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote) | Oct 2025 – Present

- Designed and operate the Minakami Referral Program, architecting a full referral-tracking workflow with AI assistance; independently manage partner coordination, lead generation, and invoicing end to end, functioning much like an external contractor and vendor network.
- Independently source, screen, and evaluate candidates across multiple concurrent hiring pipelines, building structured evaluation scorecards and ranked shortlists for founder review.
- Manage inbox and calendar for the Founder & CMO, maintaining a tightly structured schedule with zero missed communications.
- Conduct high-volume research and deliver daily end-of-day executive reporting through a custom AI-assisted workflow, alongside ongoing competitor and market research.
- Partner directly with the founder on brand protection, conducting persistent research and follow-through to identify counterfeit listings across Shopify, Meta, and TikTok, and filing enforcement claims through to resolution.
- Use Claude and ChatGPT daily to accelerate research, workflow design, and structured analysis, applying strong human review and quality control to every output.

Executive Assistant to the Managing Partner & Founder

Selva Ventures

Los Angeles, CA (Remote) | 2023 – 2025

- Served as the central operational hub across executive, business, recruiting, research, and personal priorities for a venture capital Managing Partner, operating as a single point of accountability across work and life.
- Reclaimed 10+ hours per week of executive time, triaging a dual Gmail inbox of 50–100 emails/day and reducing principal email time from roughly 90 minutes to under 20 minutes daily.
- Coordinated 20–35 meetings per month end to end with zero scheduling touch from the principal, owning full calendar architecture and venue research for in-person meetings.
- Sourced, screened, and managed contractors and service providers, including nannies, first-aid instructors, fitness coaches, and handymen, evaluating options and coordinating logistics through completion.
- Conducted investor and endowment fund research using Apollo and LinkedIn research tools to support outreach for funding to potential investors.
- Managed high-touch personal projects including a full family relocation from San Francisco to Los Angeles, and coordinated gifting for family, friends, investors, and internal team members.
- Established recurring personal logistics systems, including dental, grooming, vehicle, passport, and NEXUS appointments.
- Screened 200+ MBA intern applicants through a full-cycle recruitment process, building a curated shortlist for the firm's Director and Principal and owning end-to-end candidate communications.
- Maintained a live CRM of 8,000+ contacts on Affinity, ensuring data integrity and enabling rapid relationship lookups for deal flow and investor outreach.
- Owned monthly expense consolidation and quarterly financial reporting across Expensify, Excel, and Carta on behalf of both principals.

"MJ punches far above the weight of a typical EA. His decision to move on from Selva Ventures is a big loss for the firm, but a big win for his next employer."

Kiva Dickinson, Founder & Managing Partner, Selva Ventures — [read the full recommendation on LinkedIn](#)

Executive Assistant to the President

Meson Capital

San Francisco, CA (Remote) | 2022

- Supported the President with inbox management across Gmail and Outlook, coordinated stakeholder scheduling across Google Calendar and Trello, and built and maintained the firm's contact database on Airtable with Zapier automation.

Executive Partner

Athena

Cebu City, Philippines | 2022

- Completed Athena's rigorous Executive Assistant training program, building competencies across inbox management, calendar systems, travel logistics, research, CRM, and executive communications. Selected as one of three EAs for Athena's VIP client training track, an accelerated program preparing EAs for principal-level engagements.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

AI & Automation	Claude (daily, advanced proficiency), ChatGPT, Zapier
Project Mgmt	Notion, Trello, Asana, Slack, Zoom
Recruiting & Outreach	Apollo, LinkedIn, LinkedIn Research Tools
Productivity	Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Outlook, Dropbox
CRM	Affinity, Airtable, Notion
Finance	Expensify, Moss
Creative	Canva, Adobe Acrobat, Adobe Audition, Audacity

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in English, Major in Applied Linguistics — Cebu Technological University, Argao Campus

REFERENCES

[Kiva Dickinson](#) — Founder & Managing Partner, Selva Ventures

[Abby Diamond](#) — Former Client Success Lead, Athena

Both references are mutual LinkedIn connections and available for reference calls upon request.